# Fostering Future-Fit Leadership

*A hypothesis and strategy to address the 21st century leadership challenge.*

This is a static extraction of a live interactive map available **here**.

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# Fostering future-fit leadership

Humanity's astounding progress through the Industrial and Technological revolutions has created an immense challenge and opportunity for the 21st century.

Navigating this in Australia requires:

1. **A leadership hypothesis** — A diagnosis of the leadership challenges for the 21st century, and a hypothesis on how to address them; and,
2. **A future-fit Australia** — Strategies to cultivate future-fit leadership for all Australians.

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## The 21st century leadership challenge

We humans are astoundingly resilient. Our history is replete with major transformations as we navigate challenges and increase human thriving.

Our collective ingenuity has resulted in ever-faster feedback loops across ever-more interconnected economies, societies and ecosystems. The result is previously unimaginable levels of human prosperity... and a polycrisis. Complex issues like climate change, entrenched disadvantage, and social distrust in institutions are now intertwined and impossible to solve in isolation.

The problem is our systems of leadership development are outmoded. There is a growing complexity capability gap between rising levels of complexity and our collective ability to respond.

Closing the complexity gap is the 21st Century leadership challenge we seek to tackle.

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## A hypothesis for future-fit leadership

We hypothesise that addressing the 21st century leadership challenge (closing the complexity gap) requires cultivating future-fit leadership at multiple levels.

## Future-fit leadership

Navigating the polycrisis requires distributed leadership that can manage ever high levels of complexity.

But what does outstanding, future-fit leadership look like? How can it be cultivated?

We build out validated understandings of outstanding leadership, and amplify a movement to embed outstanding leadership across Australia.

# Levels of Leadership

Our hypothesis is interrogated through multiple lines of inquiries — related to different levels of leadership required to close the complexity gap.

## 1. Purpose

Purpose is the north star of future-fit leadership.

Individually, our personal raison d'être, and associated values and tenets of faith anchors us in crisis, and helps us navigate complexity.

Collectively, a common purpose is the only sustainable basis for people to collectively achieve a greater good.

**i.** What role does purpose play in leadership of self, others, and systems?

## 2. Leadership of self

Leadership requires us to develop our inner capacity to lead, beginning with each of us clarifying our personal purpose.

**ii.** How can we cultivate our inner capacities—self-awareness, resilience, adaptability, and moral grounding—needed to engage with increasing levels of complexity?

**iii.** What developmental practices build the capacity to “think at higher orders” (e.g., systems thinking, integrative perspective-taking) while remaining grounded in values and purpose?

**iv.** What gives us the wherewithal to take initiative in face of opposition and act on our purpose and values?

**v.** What role does leadership of self play in leadership with others and in systems?

## 3. Leading with others

Leadership in increasingly fragmented societies requires people able to multiple perspectives, foster trust, and bridge divides across groups and cultures that operate at different levels of complexity.

**vi.** How do people foster trust, empathy, and generative dialogue across diverse groups operating at different levels of complexity?

**vii.** What developmental practices build the capacity to “think at higher orders” (e.g., systems thinking, integrative perspective-taking) while remaining grounded in values and purpose?

**viii.** What gives us the wherewithal to take initiative in face of opposition and act on our purpose and values?

**ix.** What relational capabilities help people bridge divides and hold multiple, often conflicting perspectives in polarized environments?

## 4. Leading in systems

System leadership is not positions held by privileged individuals but a distributed practice across networks.

Complex problems are held in place by systems of organisations, their policies, practices and resource flows, and wider social priorities, values, mindsets and mental models.

Navigating the polycrisis therefore requires collective efforts by networks of people within and across systems.

**x.** How do leaders enable organizations to adapt and thrive within complex, layered systems of stakeholders, institutions, and power dynamics?

**xi.** What capabilities allow leaders to design cultures and structures that integrate learning, innovation, and accountability across multiple levels of hierarchy and complexity?

## 5. Inter-cultural leadership

At the highest level of national and global action, leadership is an act of stewardship for a Public Good.

**xii.** How can leadership be cultivated as a public good, capable of stewarding not just organizations but entire societies through layers of civic, cultural, and global complexity?

**xiii.** What forms of leadership are required to reconcile short-term pressures with long-term, intergenerational responsibilities?

**xiv.** How do cultural traditions shape leadership responses to complexity, and what can global leaders learn from these varied approaches?

**xv.** How can leaders remain rooted in their own cultural context while operating effectively across global systems marked by diverse values and hierarchical challenges?

## 6. Developing leadership capability

Narrowing the capability gap of leadership in complexity requires cultivation of leadership of self, with others and in systems.

**xvi.** Which developmental pathways best build the ability to lead across increasing levels of hierarchical complexity?

**xvii.** How should leadership development programs measure progress—beyond skills—to capture growth in developmental capacity, purpose, navigating complexity, and societal impact?

# Priority cohorts

We focus on four priority cohorts where leadership capability can drive systemic change at scale.

## Citizens (Community resilience)

Communities today face deep challenges — poverty, housing shortages, racism, family violence, climate disasters, and mental ill-health. These problems are interconnected and exceed the capacity of any single authority. Citizen leaders bring lived experience and informal influence that can cut through silos and drive collaboration.

In our Comunity resilience sandbox, we innovate with new ways to build Citizens' capacity to strengthen community resilience, at scale.

Learn more **here**.

## Young people (Youth development)

Australia's next generation faces unprecedented challenges. They will need to be collaborative, adaptive, and systemic in their leadership.

Climate change, inequality, and social fragmentation create complex challenges that no single institution can solve. Young people bring energy, innovation, and diverse perspectives — but they need practical opportunities to develop leadership capacity.

In our Youth development sandbox, we innovate with new ways to build Young people's leadership capacity, at scale.

Learn more **here**.

## Teachers (Education outcomes)

Schools face complex challenges: rising student needs, workforce shortages, equity demands, and staff burnout.

The most powerful driver of student achievement is Collective Teacher Efficacy — the shared belief among educators that they can make a difference. Yet many school leaders lack training in collaborative, distributed leadership.

In our Education sandbox, we innovate with new ways to build School teachers' capacity to improve education outcomes, at scale.

Learn more **here**.

## Indigenous women (Indigenous self-determination)

Indigenous women are building enterprises that weave cultural knowledge, community strength, and economic independence.

Existing support programs often fail Indigenous women — imposing Western business models, neglecting community contexts, and exacerbating trauma. Despite this, Indigenous women are demonstrating powerful leadership, creating businesses that sustain families, protect culture, and strengthen community resilience.

In our Sandbox for Indigenous Women, we innovate with new ways to build Indigenous women's capacity to lead for themselves, their family and Country, at scale.

Learn more **here**.

# System levers

We identify systemic levers that can shift mental models, structures, and resource flows to strengthen leadership across Australia.

## COMMUNITY RESILIENCE

### Culture

Developing and dissimenating evidence-based narratives of community aspiration, and what is needed to realise it, is a high potential systemic lever to strengthen community resilience nationally, for two reasons:

• Scalability: New narratives are arguably the most viral of human activities, with delivery extremely scalable through legacy and social media.

• Impact: Shifting our mental models is the most direct means to deliver transformative impact on complex challenges like community resilience.

### Capability

Strengthening commmunity resilience requires citizens empowered to lead together. Capacity and capability in this context is collective, distributed and grounded in each communities' values, priorities and cultures. However, traditional education institutions and online training platforms are not currently well placed or well versed in building relational capabilitiy.

Identifying and developing scalable but relational models to build citizens' collecitve capability, deliverable in community settings, is a promising systemic level to strengthen citizen leadership nationally.

### Capital

A sustainable stack of grants and finance to underwrite community plans will deliver the capital need to shift impact from isolated, philanthropically funded pilots to delivering impact at scale nationally.

Altering capital flows at scale (a.k.a. 'resource flows') is also arguably the most direct means to effect structural change and sustainably shift systems.

### Governance

Appropriate governance has been long-understood as a crucial lever to strengthen community resilience in ways that are both effective and empower citizens. However, recent technological develompents allow for new forms of governance that drive autonomy, agility, and accountability to community and achieve economies of scale.

## YOUTH DEVELOPMENT

### International exchange

International exchange and dialogue is an extremely rich space in which individuals can clarify their personal purpose, learn how to engage others across cultural and social divides, and define a greater good to which we can all contribute.

More systemically, our collective future depends on values-driven people collaborating across borders, and addressing local challenges in ways that support sustainable, inclusive development, and a harmonious international order.

## EDUCATION OUTCOMES

## Curriculum

The educational system - and associated curriculum - is one of the primary vehicles operating at scale through which many young Australians can be supported to develop their leadership capabilities.

## Teacher training

Fostering a sense of teachers' collective efficacy is a powerful driver of improved student outcomes. However, there is substantial uncertainty around how to effectively cultivate it in a sector that historically emphasised hierarchies and individidual 'hero' models of leadership.

Teacher training and continuing professional develompent (CPD) provides a highly scalable mechanism to support schools in developing the leadership capacity necessary to achieve better educational outcomes.

### INDIGENOUS SELF-DETERMINATION

## Entrepreneurship

Enterpreneurship and economic empowerment has always been a key plank in Indigenous people's self-determination. It ius also a scalable, strength-based approach to building Indigenous women’s agency, autonomy and skills. It shifts mental models, system practices and resource flows.

### INSIGHT AND INFLUENCE

## Evidence

Outstanding leadership today requires clarity of purpose, shared values, and the capacity to act collectively. But how do we measure and cultivate it at scale?

The concept of leadership is highly contested, with too little reference to empirical evidence on the qualities and characteristics of outstanding leadership, let alone how to build leadership at scale.

In our Insight workstream and sandbox, we seek to deepen the Evidence base on building outstanding leadership.

## Media

Leadership today must be collaborative, adaptive, distributed, and grounded in values. The stories we tell shape the leadership culture we create.

In our Influence workstream and sandbox, we seek to change the narrative and improve public understanding of outstanding leadership.

# Our Workstreams

## Incubation

We catalyse partnerships in selected ‘sandboxes’ to tackle challenges of national significance, and test new ways to strengthen leadership capability at scale.

**Our approach to Innovation:**

- Target high-potential ‘acupuncture points’ within a system to unlock leadership potential and drive lasting change.
- Bring together practitioners, experts, and scale partners, with lived experience at the centre, to sense-make, trial, and iterate.
- Co-design initiatives that deliver tangible outcomes, system change, and elevate the leadership narrative.

## Insight

We partner with researchers to distill insights from our sandboxes, and build and synthesise the evidence on outstanding leadership.

**Core characteristics of outstanding leadership:**

- Outstanding leaders have clarity of purpose, understand the values that define them, continually improve their competence, and are disposed to act for the ‘greater good.’
- Outstanding leadership on complex challenges is symbiotic — it fosters collective efficacy, builds collaborative capacity, builds cognitive complexity, and mobilises actors across sectors actors around a common goal.
- Effective leadership capacity programs integrate individual and collective growth, and provide action-based opportunities to navigate evolving real-world complex problems.

## Influence

We partner with diverse actors to galvanise public understanding of effective leadership in complexity, and elevate the broader leadership narrative.

**Our influencing priorities:**

- Encouraging people to clarify their purpose and values, appreciate our collective responsibility to each other, and act for the greater good.
- Building demand for leadership adequate to complexity - values-based, collaborative, adaptive and forward-thinking.
- Strengthening leadership storytelling, in line with the values and principles that underpin outstanding leadership: integrity, clear purpose, respect for all.

# Initiatives

## Building Victorian Leadership Capability Initiative (2024–2026)

**Community resilience** Incubation

The Victorian Leadership Initiative amplifies the impact of Victorian community leadership programs.

The partners are developing cross-regional, sustainable, systemic approaches to cultivate leadership that can rise to the challenges of our time.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

## Climate Discovery Project (2020–2022)

**Community resilience** Incubation

The Climate Discovery Project purpose is threefold: (i) to explore how climate change perpetuates inequity by sharing insights from community leadership experiences; (ii) to identify and document the opportunities and conditions that strengthen community capacity and agency to respond effectively to the growing impacts of climate change, and (iii) to examine a range of systemic climate change interventions aimed at promoting increased equity, community leadership, and collective action.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

## Economic Development for Community Resilience in Regional Victoria (2026–2027)

**Community resilience** Incubation

This initiative seeks to strengthen collective understanding of when and how economic development can catalyse citizen leadership and community resilience, and what is required to support many communities at scale, to harness economic development in support of community resilience.

Partners in this initiative will:

• Codify the ongoing leadership lessons from regional exemplars of community-led entrepreneurship and economic development;

• Produce and disseminate story telling pieces and accessible leadership resources;

• Deepen collaboration across regional anchor organisations; and

• Develop further strategies to systemically harness entrepreneurship and economic development to work that strengthens community resilience.

Learn more about the initiative here.

## Participatory Melbourne (2024–2026)

**Community resilience** Incubation Insight

The Participatory Melbourne intiative seeks to identify scalable platforms to deepen our understanding of community in a post-COVID world and contribute to the development of the narrative and infrastructure required to build community agency, increase trust,
foster connectedness and inspire active citizen participation.

Phase 1 involves a series of workshops to identify key drivers and strategies. Phase 2 will roll out a number of transformative projects to build citizen leadership and community resilience.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

### Reimagining a civil Australia (2025–2026)

**Community resilience** Incubation
The Menzies Leadership Foundation has convened a coalition to make sense of the challenges and opportunities around civility, unearth new insights, and co-develop an inclusive response.

Our goal is bold: to reimagine a more civil Australia with a unifying narrative about race and diversity and a national platform for action that helps all Australians engage constructively across differences and strengthen their communities' resilience.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

### Tasmania Community Resilience Initiative (2025–2027)

**Community resilience** Incubation
Learn more about the initiative **here**.

### Web3 Community Governance (2023)

**Community resilience** Incubation
Learn more about the initiative here.

### Policy Fellowships (2023–2028)

**Youth development** Incubation
Menzies Leadership Foundation and Global Voices are partnering to extend the reach of Global Voices National scholarship program. It will result in additional scholarships to support exceptional 18-30 year old Australians to develop their leadership capacity through participation in Australian delegations to highly influential multilateral fora such as the IMF, the World Bank and various bodies of the United Nations.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

### Ethical Futures by Design (2023–2026)

**Education outcomes** Incubation
Ethics by Design: Leading New Futures is a curriculum-aligned leadership initiative co-developed by the Ethics Centre, the Menzies Leadership Foundation and a youth advisory council. The intiiative developed a one-term interdisciplinary leadership program where students bring their creativity, passion, and ideas to make a real difference in leading change.

The program is available in a variety of delivery modes to best suit teacher's needs including self-directed student completion as an extension opportunity or whole class teacher-led classroom delivery. Each option comprises approximately 11-hours of engagement time over the term and is supported by a full suite of resources, including online lessons, teacher lesson plans and student workbooks.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

### Ethics in the English Curriculum (2022–2026)

**Education outcomes** Incubation Insight
Learn more about the initiative here.

### Menzies School Leadership Incubator (2022–2025)

**Education outcomes** Incubation Insight
The incubator aims to build a pipeline of school leaders equipped and empowered to lead in increasingly challenging and complex settings.

Its approach acknowledges the interplay between individual, team, and systemic dynamics in achieving better student learning outcomes. Drawing on research into 'collective efficacy,' it takes a holistic view of school improvement: collective efficacy is now perceived not just as an end goal but as part of a broader strategy that includes leadership development, team dynamics, and systemic improvement. This transition signifies a strategic pivot from focusing solely on collective efficacy to leveraging it as a vital component within a wider array of improvement strategies.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

### Indigenous women entreneurship initiative (2021–2027)

**Indigenous self-determination** Incubation
Learn more about the initiative here.

### Australasian leadership initiative (2023–2026)

**Insight and influence** Influence
Home to half of humanity, Asia will increasingly be the source of global consensus on strategies to tackle our most pressing challenges, including climate crises, geopolitical turmoil, and techno-economic disruption.

Inspired by Sir Robert Menzies' 1950s re-positioning of Australia in Asia using education and exchange (the 'Colombo Plan'), the Menzies Leadership Foundation is exploring different ways to partner internationally and support leadership and collaboration in the Southeast Asian region.

Learn more about the initiative here.

### Australian Leadership Index (2024)

**Insight and influence** Insight
The Australian Leadership Index is the largest ever ongoing research study of leadership in Australia.

In the wider context of Australians tired of leaders and institutions that prioritise self-interest over the broader public interest, the index tracks public perceptions of leadership across the government, public, private, and not for profit sectors.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

### Complexity Leadership Lab (2024–2028)

**Insight and influence** Insight
The Complexity Leadership Lab is a transdisciplinary research initiative led by experts in leadership, complexity science, systems, and cybernetics from the Australian National University (ANU), in collaboration with the Menzies Foundation.

The lab brings together scholars from diverse disciplinary backgrounds and practice fields, to developing innovations in leadership thinking and challenging long-held assumptions about its nature and development.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

## Menzies Oration (2018–2026)

**Insight and influence** Insight Incubation

The Menzies Oration is an annual keynote event exploring leadership in the context of contemporary challenges.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

## MedTech Fellowships (2020–2024)

**Technology leadership** Incubation

The MedTech Actuator Menzies Fellowship is designed to expose senior researchers to entrepreneurship, commercialisation and the startup ecosystem in order to unlock the potential of Australia's world-class research.

The MedTech Actuator Menzies Fellowship is a partnership between the Menzies Foundation and MedTech Actuator, which will support the scientific community's commercialisation capacity by facilitating knowledge transfer from industry to researchers.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

## Ninian Stephen Law Program (2021–2024)

**Technology leadership** Insight

The program builds capacity in the legal profession to respond to the challenges of emerging technologies. The program tests the limits and possibilities to regulation of technology, drawing on a model of systems thinking that is commonly learnt by engineering and computer science students, and studies how people and human-artifacts interact.

It brings together leading thinkers from the legal profession, information technology, computing and engineering to investigate: the ramifications of emerging technologies; the risks of harm arising from reliance on such technologies; and the most effective ways of building resilient legal, regulatory and governance approaches to those technologies. It uses these insights to develop thought leadership, policy, training and education packages in Australia, and collaborate more widely in the Asia Pacific.

Learn more about the initiative **here**.

# Outputs

Reports, events, tools and resources produced by our initiatives.

### Active Participation towards a common good (2023)

**Community resilience** Incubation Insight from *Participatory Melbourne*
This report captures insights from work to cultivate a place-based movement to foster new forms of leadership, and create the conditions for a thriving civic life.

It identifies four creative pathways that will allow people to 'walk side by side into the future without always seeing eye to eye.' These are bonding neighbourhoods, activating the commons, rewiring value, and realigning institutions.

Read the report **here**.

### Ballarat Civility Exchange (2025–2026)

**Community resilience** Incubation from *Reimagining a civil Australia*
170 years after Eureka, Ballarat is stepping forward to tackle hard things together. The Civility Exchange listens to where trust between people is being built, where it's holding steady, and where it's wearing thin — and what it takes to build it back.

THe Exchange uses an online dashboard to live snapshot of the impact of the Ballarat Living Lab for everyday civility — learning where connection is breaking down, where it's already strong, and testing simple ways to strengthen how we show up with each other.

View the online dashboard **here**.

### Community led responses to climate change (2024)

**Community resilience** Incubation from *Climate Discovery Project*
This report reveals the systemic barriers to local agency and autonomy while also showcasing the enabling conditions for community-led responses.

It serves to uncover the links between social justice and climate change impacts in place-based contexts by learning from the experience of communities experiencing climate impacts. Recommendations are made on three opportunities to support community-led action on climate change while also addressing inequities, covering collective learning systems, new funding mechanisms, and collaborative governance.

Read the report **here**.

### Web3 for Social Change Report (2023)

**Community resilience** Incubation from *Web3 Community Governance*
This paper explores the potential for Web3 to radically shift who holds power in the design of financial innovations, with emphasis on community finance and related themes.

It examines existing and hypothetical applications of Web3 for community finance; analyzes the power dynamics at play within Web3 financial innovations; outlines specific strategies for addressing those power dynamics, with examples of transformative projects underway; and offers recommendations for potential next steps

Read the report **here**.

### Cultivating Collective Efficacy Report (2023)

**Education outcomes** Incubation Insight from *Menzies School Leadership Incubator*

Despite significant investment in leadership development, the school leadership pipeline in Australia is in crisis. We need a new approach to leadership that supports school leaders to better manage transformational change and deepen collaborative capacity
necessary to cultivate collective efficacy to improve student learning outcomes.

This report outlines insights from the Menzies School Leadership Incubator. The Incubator has developed a Collective Efficacy Tracking Tool to support school teacher teams' confidence and ability to collectively deliver education outcomes. The tool has already played a significant role in supporting schools to understand, diagnose and cultivate collective efficacy.

Read the report **here**.

### Cultivating Collective Efficacy Webinar (2022)

**Education outcomes** Incubation Insight from *Menzies School Leadership Incubator*

The education system currently focuses on the development of individual leaders. However, to build collective efficacy we need to focus on both leader and leadership development, a combination of leadership of self, leadership of others and leadership of systems.

This webinar with Professor John Hattie explores how schools can navigate increasingly complex and challenging contexts by helping leaders focused on deepening collaborative capacity. This will allow schools to more efficiently and effectively harness multiple expertise, aligned, and focused on improving student learning outcomes.

Watch the webinar **here**.

### Design out Racism Challenge (2025)

**Education outcomes** Incubation from *Ethical Futures by Design*

This design challenge strengthens young people's ethical understanding, critical thinking and capability to act collectively on complex social issues (like racism). Through a series of interactive learning modules, Year 10 students develop a personal ethics framework and apply it to a real-world challenge: racism in their communities.

Working in teams, students design a practical response and present their ideas through a one-minute “Video for Change” — encouraging empathy, awareness and action. The program combines ethics education, systems thinking and collaborative design, helping students move beyond identifying problems to imagining and creating solutions.

Learn more about the challenge **here**.

### Rising Team for Schools (2025)

**Education outcomes** Incubation Insight from *Menzies School Leadership Incubator*

Rising Team for Schools is a digital service that helps school leaders and educators grow together with a comprehensive curriculum and tools to strengthen collective efficacy. The platform includes software-guided workshops, built-in surveys and an AI coach.

Access the tool **here**.

### Case studies of Indigenous Women Entrepreneur Ecosystems (2025)

**Indigenous self-determination** Incubation from *Indigenous women entreneurship initiative*

These case study attempt to understand the ecosystems that five Indigenous women entrepreneurs in the Kimberley, work with, and within. In their own words, each woman provides a glimpse into their experiences and journeys into business. They also share how they have managed to establish themselves despite all the challenges they have had to endure and continue to endure.

These women are not just doing business – they are accessing and sharing cultural knowledge, connecting, drawing on custodial lands and water and importantly collaborating with members of their immediate family and community. Business is not just what they do – it represents who they are and what they stand for.

Read the report **here**.

### Community-Centered Blended Finance Report (2023)

**Indigenous self-determination** Incubation from *Indigenous women entreneurship initiative*

This report outlines how to transform the use of blended finance to build community wealth in ways that are non-extractive, help heal historic trauma, and support Indigenous self-determination.

Read the report **here**.

### Narratives of Indigenous Women Entrepreneur Ecosystems (2024)

**Indigenous self-determination** Incubation from *Indigenous women entreneurship initiative*

This documents aims to strengthen the understanding of the ecosystems that Indigenous women entrepreneurs in the Kimberley, and in rural and remote Australia, work with, and within.

The experience of trauma interplays in different ways within the ecosystems, with many implications philanthropists, impact investors, policy makers and the ‘business support sector.”

Read the document **here**.

### Yarning Business Podcast (2023)

**Indigenous self-determination** Incubation from *Indigenous women entreneurship initiative*

A podcast series hosted by Menzies Leadership Foundation partner Natasha Short from Kimberley Jiyigas exploring how Indigenous women are using entrepreneurship to support themselves, their family and community, and Country.

Access the podcast **here**.

### Civic Health In Australia - National Potrait (2024)

**Insight and influence** Insight from *Australian Leadership Index*

This report outlines the state of civic health in Australia through 30 charts from Australian and international research teams. It outlines decline of public trust in and satisfaction with Australia’s social institutions or those who lead them. They are increasingly seen as self-serving, and putting self and vested interests ahead of the wider public interest. It also helps readers, as citizens and established and emerging leaders, understand how they can contribute to the regeneration of a thriving civic life.

Read the report **here**.

### Hugh de Kretser Oration (2026)

**Insight and influence** Insight Incubation from *Menzies Oration*

The 2026 Menzies Oration, hosted by Federation University, was delivered by Mr Hugh de Kretser. Hugh has worked to advance human rights in Australia for more than 2 decades.

He has a legal background, in corporate employment law, and with community legal centres. He was the CEO of the Yoorrook Justice Commission, the first formal truth-telling process into historical and ongoing injustices experienced by First Peoples in Victoria, and is currently the President of the Australian Human Rights Commission.

Hugh's Oration focussed on social cohesion, democracy, trust, listening and human rights. The subsequent Q&A; explored his personal career, what he learned working closely with Indigenous people in Victoria on truth-telling, and what is needed to foster justice and leadership in Australia.

Read the Oration **here**.

### Jennifer Dulski Oration (2023)

**Insight and influence** Insight Incubation from *Menzies Oration*

The 2023 Menzies Oration, hosted by Federation University, was delivered by Ms Jennifer Dulski. Jennifer is CEO & Founder at Rising Team, Faculty at Stanford GSB, and bestselling author of Purposeful. She has held leadership roles at Facebook, Google and Yahoo!, and founder, CEO and president roles at early stage and scaling startups.

Jennifer spoke on the essential qualities and strategies necessary for effective leadership in an AI-driven world.

Watch the Oration **here**.

### Kim Williams Oration (2024)

**Insight and influence** Insight Incubation from *Menzies Oration*

The 2024 Menzies Oration, hosted by Federation University, was delivered by Mr Kim Williams AM. Kim is leader with an extraordinary career spanning arts, entertainment, and media industries both in Australia and internationally. He was appointed Chair of the Australian Broadcasting Corporation in 2024.

In his Oration Kim shared insights drawn from decades of experience, exploring the vital connection between leadership and truth and highlighting the essential qualities that define ethical leadership in the 21st century.

Watch the Oration **here**.

### New Challenges, New Leaders (2024)

**Insight and influence** Influence from *Australasian leadership initiative*

Leaders today face a multitude of intersecting risks and challenges spanning rapid technological advancements, growing geopolitical risks and the intensification of climate change effects. Leadership itself must go beyond traditional roles to meet today’s complex and challenging landscape with a new, adaptive style.

The Economist Impact report outlines the evolving nature of leadership in the public, private and non-profit sectors against a backdrop of mega trends spanning technological, climate and geopolitical forces impacting the current and future role of leaders across the globe.

Read the report **here**.

## Tasmania Leading in Complexity (2024)

**Insight and influence** Insight from *Complexity Leadership Lab*

This report explores how complexity influences leadership in the state of Tasmania, including the nature of the complexities leaders encounter, how they make sense of these challenges, and the support leaders need to navigate them effectively.

It provides recommendations on how to help leaders adopt systems thinking, collaboration, digital and techonological competency, and innovation to effectively navigate complexity while balancing preservation and economic progress.

Read the report **here**.

## Travers McLeod Oration (2022)

**Insight and influence** Insight Incubation from *Menzies Oration*

The 2022 Menzies Oration, hosted by Federation University, was delivered by Mr Travers McLeod, Executive Director, Brotherhood of St. Laurence.

Travers spoke to the question 'Do I have a future? A better deal for young people in Australia'. Travers was then joined by a panel of young leaders to set a future agenda for the 'greater good'.

View the transcript **here**.

## New Legal Thinking for Emerging Technologies (2024)

**Technology leadership** Insight from *Ninian Stephen Law Program*

This report identifies how Australian lawyers are currently ill-equipped to deal with the coming wave of emerging technology. It identifies gaps in legal skills and organisational structures, outdated perceptions of the role of lawyers.

It provides recommendations on education, training and legal involvement in organisational processes; to help deliver a paradigm shift in lawyers are risk identifiers to proactive problem solvers that promote high level and ethical standards in technology adoption.

Read the report **here**.

## Synthesis Capital (2025)

**Technology leadership** Incubation from *MedTech Fellowships*

Synthesis Capital has been established as an integrated investment platform focused on early-stage deep health technology.

The platform brings together capital, venture-building capability, sector expertise and global networks to support high-potential companies translating breakthrough health technologies into global markets.

Learn more about the fund **here**.

## Unlocking the Potential of Science Commercialisation (2025)

**Technology leadership** Incubation from *MedTech Fellowships*

This whitepaper presents a summary of the outcomes, key learnings, and recommendations stemming from two two national science entrepreneurship programmes, designed to bridge the gap between scientific research and commercialisation by equipping researchers with essential entrepreneurial skills.

Australia's ability to lead in health technology innovation lies in creating a robust, synergistic ecosystem that integrates capital, connectivity, and capability. Moving beyond individual successes and ad hoc initiatives, the report envisions a systemic transformation to position Australia as a
global leader in health and medical commercialisation.

Read the report **here**.

# Partners

We partner with universities, foundations, peak bodies and community organisations across Australia and internationally to catalyse new ways to build leadership capacity.

### Australian Council for Educational Research

ACER's mission is to create and promote research-based knowledge, products and services that can be used to improve learning across the lifespan. They are a not-for-profit research organisation established in Australia. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Australian National University

The Australian National University is a world-leading university in Australia's capital. Excellence is embedded in their approach to research and education. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Ballarat Foundation

The Ballarat Foundation enables giving to build thriving communities free from disadvantage in the Ballarat region. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Castlemaine Institute

The Castlemaine Institute is a research and learning not-for-profit specialising in regional place-based change. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Coalition of Everyone

Coalition of Everyone was an organisation dedicated to repairing and building democracy into the fabric of everyday life. It used participatory and deliberative practices, co-creating a future where collective wisdom is celebrated in service of a healthy and equitable planet. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Collaboration for Impact

Collaboration for Impact help people collaborate in ways that changes power and transform systems—so all people and Country can thrive. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Criterion Institute

Criterion is a US-based nonprofit think tank dedicated to expanding possibilities for how finance can be used for social change. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Economist Impact

The Economist Impact partners with corporations, foundations, NGOs and governments across big themes including sustainability, health and the changing shape of globalisation to catalyse change and enable progress. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Ethics Centre

The Ethics Centre develop and deliver innovative programs, services and experiences, to bring ethics to the centre of personal and professional life. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### FECCA

FECCA is the national peak body representing people from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds. FECCA's role is to advocate and promote issues on behalf of its constituency to government, business and the broader community. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Federation University

Federation University is regional Victoria's largest education institution. They have campuses in Ballarat, Berwick, Gippsland and the Wimmera. They are a university and a TAFE. They offer a range of courses that link directly to current industry trends. But what the're most proud of is their diverse student community. Learn more about the organisation here.

### Global Voices

Global Voices is a youth-led Australian not-for-profit committed to developing the next generation of leaders by providing practical experience in policymaking, international relations, and diplomacy. Learn more about the organisation here.

### Good Return

Good Return is a social purpose organisation working across the Asia Pacific region. They enable women and their families to access opportunity and build financial security. Learn more about the organisation here.

### Good Wolf

Good Wolf helps their clients feed their ‘GoodWolf’■ in building a stronger, fairer and more sustainable civil societies. Learn more about the organisation here.

### Jesuit Social Services

Jesuit Social Services is an Australian non-profit, working for more than 45 years to deliver practical support and advocating for improved policies, legislation and resources to achieve strong, cohesive and vibrant communities where every individual can reach their full potential. Learn more about the organisation here.

### Leadership Victoria

Leadership Victoria is the pre-eminent leadership organisation in Victoria, and has been delivering unique programs for over 30 years. Learn more about the organisation here.

### Local & Independent News Association

Local & Independent News Association (LINA) is a not-for-profit industry association supporting a movement of local and independent digital news publishers. Learn more about the organisation here.

### Maganda Makers

The Maganda Makers Business Club is an initiative that has been established to empower Kimberley Indigenous Women to build wealth through business. Learn more about the organisation here.

### MAVLab

MAVLab, housed within the Municipal Assocation of Victoria, is innovation lab working on the future of local government. Learn more about the organisation here.

### MedTech Actuator

MedTech Actuator empowers founders to turn big health ideas into global impact, accelerating innovation, connecting ecosystems, and helping you scale with purpose. Learn more about the organisation here.

### Mparntwe Alice Springs Community Foundation

Mparntwe Alice Springs Community Foundation supports community efforts to build a ‘stronger community and shared future’ for Mparntwe Alice Springs. Learn more about the organisation here.

### Office for Social Cohesion

Housed within the Australian Commonwealth Department of Home Affairs, the Office for Social Cohesion works to strengthen social cohesion and democratic resilience in Australia. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Paper Giant

Paper Giant is a design agency that helps clidents solve complex problems in sustainable ways. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Purpose Made

Purpose Made is a consulting firm that supports organisations to deliver real environmental and social impact. Their services include measuring social impact, launching new ventures and developing strategies. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Regen Melbourne

Regen Melbourne is an engine for collaboration in service of the regeneration of Greater Melbourne. Powered by a community of more than 200 organisations, we're working towards a thriving future for people and planet. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Regional Leadership Collective

The Regional Leadership Collective is the peak body for nine community leadersihp organisations service regional Victoria since 1996. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Rising Team

Rising Team is a California-based technology platform to help turn every manager into a confident leader of a high performing team. Their platform includes software-guided team workshops that boost connection and performance, and an AI coach tailored to every manager, every team, and every company, at **here**.

### Swinburne University

Swinburne is a Melbourne-based, world-ranked university leading the way in innovation, industry engagement and social inclusion. Their education, high-quality research and industry partnerships create positive change for students, staff and the community. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Tasmanian Leaders

Tasmanian Leaders is Tasmania's premier leadership development charity and not-for-profit organisation. They amplify the leadership potential and influence of Tasmanians to inspire and build a brighter future for our State. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### University of Melbourne Centre for AI and Digital Ethics

The Centre for Artificial Intelligence and Digital Ethics (CAIDE) builds cross-disciplinary research, teaching, policy and regulatory expertise. CAIDE is founded as a collaboration between the University of Melbourne Faculty of Engineering and Information Technology and Melbourne Law School. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

### Welcoming Australia

Welcoming Australia is a non-partisan movement and organisation committed to cultivating a culture of welcome and advancing an Australia where people of all backgrounds have equal opportunity to belong, contribute and thrive. Learn more about the organisation **here**.

# Learn more

The Menzies Leadership Foundation works at the intersection of practice, research and culture through three priorities:

- **Incubation** — Catalysing partnerships that build leadership capability.
- **Insight** — Synthesising research and data to advance the field of leadership in complexity.
- **Influence** — Elevating public narratives on leadership, integrity and collective responsibility.

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Learn more about future-fit leadership and explore the interactive map at menziesfoundation.org.au.

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